
North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

August 27, 2025

Mr. Matthew Adamec
Plant Sciences, Inc.
234 Juniper Knoll Rd
Macdoel, CA 96058
Madamec@plantsciences.com

Dear Mr. Adamec,

Subject: Notice of Applicability of General Order WQ-2014-0153-DWQ, Plant Sciences, Inc. Macdoel Middle School, Macdoel, Siskiyou County

File: Plant Sciences, Inc. Macdoel Middle School, 13001 Old State Highway, Macdoel, Siskiyou County, WDID No. 1A25094RSIS; CIWQS Place No. 901636

This letter serves as Notice of Applicability (NOA) from the North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) that General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order) is applicable to the subject wastewater system and that the system is henceforth regulated under the General Order as described below. This letter also provides transmittal of Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) Order No. R1-2025-0026 for the subject wastewater system, attachment 2 to this NOA.

Plant Sciences, Inc. (Discharger) submitted a report of waste discharge (ROWD) application on March 3rd, 2025 for the new domestic wastewater system (Facility) located at the following coordinates in Siskiyou County: 41.817737, -122.006596. The Discharger submitted additional documentation to Siskiyou County on June 16th, 2025. The Discharger submitted an updated ROWD to the Regional Water Board on July 23, 2025. The proposed project includes retrofitting of the existing Macdoel Middle School campus into worker housing for the Discharger's seasonal agricultural activities. The campus property consists of 10 acres and is due south of the town of Macdoel along Old State Highway.

The Discharger maintains coverage for another, nearby facility, which is regulated under 97-010-DWQ and R1-2015-0027. This nearby facility is referred to as "Plant Sciences, Inc. Juniper Village" in Regional Board records. To differentiate these two facilities in Macdoel owned and operated by the same discharger, the Facility is to be covered under this Notice of Applicability and its corresponding file shall be referred to as "Plant Sciences, Inc. Macdoel Middle School" in Regional Board records.

Based on the information presented in the ROWD and the supplemental information received, the proposed domestic wastewater system and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the General Order.

The General Order contains requirements that apply to all types of wastewater systems and requirements that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Attachment 1 to this letter summarizes the operational requirements specific to Plant Sciences' Macdoel Middle School domestic wastewater system. The General Order contains additional requirements not summarized in Attachment 1. Additionally, the General Order requires compliance with Regional Water Board Basin Plan water quality objectives. The MRP, Attachment 2, contains the necessary site-specific monitoring and reporting requirements. The Discharger is responsible for all applicable requirements in the General Order and the MRP.

The General Order is available on the [State Water Resources Control Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf).

The Regional Water Board Basin Plan, Chapter 3, Water Quality Objectives, is available on the [Regional Water Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water_issues/programs/basin_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water_issues/programs/basin_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf).

Conditional County Requirements

Siskiyou County staff requested certain conditions be met in order for the discharge to comply with local density requirements. As the proposed discharge is not eligible under coverage under Tier 1 of the OWTS Policy and Siskiyou County does not have an approved LAMP, Regional Water Board staff are including certain local requirements to ensure that the discharge may proceed. These conditions were noted in a Plant Sciences letter dated 6/16/2025 sent to Siskiyou County. Namely:

1. The county's new Sewage Disposal Ordinance¹ assumes an owner of a property to be operating their wastewater system at its projected daily capacity 365 days of the year.
2. Based on that assumption, if the owner of a 10-acre, high density property like the one in question were to operate at the County's stated maximum allowed flow

¹ Sec. 5-2.18, the "density standard" maximum allowance for wastewater flow with a "Standard" wastewater treatment system, like the one that has been proposed, is 2,400 gallons per day with the lot size. This reference also allows for an increase of this flow upwards of 100 percent if wastewater flows are treated by an approved "alternative on-site" wastewater treatment system, which could bring the total allowance up to 4,800 gallons per day.

of 2,400 gallons per day, this would create an annual total production of 876,000 gallons.

3. Plant Sciences planned total annual production of wastewater at the middle school site is based on a total of 45 days of use. Thus, at the current planned production of 5,040 gallons per day, the total annual production would be 226,800 gallons, 1/4 of the maximum annual production that the county allows for under its sewage disposal ordinance.
4. If, in the future, Plant Sciences needs to increase the operational use of this facility by more than 400%, the company is required to advise the County and Regional Board and plan for the installation of an alternative on-site wastewater treatment system.²

Facility Discharge Description

The Discharger will operate the Facility along Old State Highway approximately a half mile south of the town of Macdoel. The Facility is not located in an area served by a regional wastewater collection system; therefore, domestic wastewater will be collected, treated, and disposed of on-site.

The proposed Facility will serve a 10-acre middle school campus that will be retrofitted into housing to accommodate seasonal agricultural workers. The expected occupancy is 126 persons who will reside at the site each year during an approximately 6-week work period. Contributing flows include restrooms, showers, a kitchen, and laundry facilities. The site may be used for training purposes outside of the 6-week work period. Estimated annual discharge would be expected around 227,000 gallons. If the discharger estimates actual flows above 876,000 gallons over a yearlong period, the discharger shall submit updated plans for a system with advanced treatment per the County's conditional requirements to both the County and the Regional Water Board.

California Environmental Quality Act

As an existing facility, the facility upgrade project described in this NOA is categorically exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to California Code of Regulations, title 14, section 15301, (ongoing or existing projects), section 15302 (replacement or reconstruction of existing utility systems), and section 15303 (new construction or conversion of small structures).

Site Specific Requirements and Effluent Limits

A. General

The General Order contains prohibitions and specifications that apply to all wastewater systems, and specifications that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal

² Condition (E)(2)(m)(iv) of the Order requires notification to the Regional Water Board of a material change in the character, location, or volume of discharge.

systems. Table 1 of this NOA provides a summary of applicable discharge requirements for the Facility.

Facility managers and operators must be familiar with the applicable requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and MRP R1-2025-0026.

A copy of the General Order is enclosed with this NOA. The General Order is also available on [State Water Resources Control Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf).

B. Septic Tanks

The Facility includes three septic tanks that provide primary treatment of the wastewater. The septic tanks require proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring in order to provide adequate and reliable wastewater service. This includes periodic inspection and removal, as needed, of accumulated solids. General Order Section B.2, Septic Systems, and the enclosed MRP, at section III, Septic Tank Monitoring, include requirements for the septic tanks. Qualified service providers may conduct operational maintenance and monitoring on the septic system with appropriate oversight by the Discharger. The Discharger is responsible for ensuring proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring of the septic tanks.

C. Subsurface Disposal System Requirements

The Facility's wastewater treatment/disposal process includes dispersal of treated effluent to subsurface soil via a conventional leach field system. Subsurface disposal systems shall hold in reserve sufficient land area for possible future 100-percent replacement of the subsurface disposal system or establish an equivalent contingency that is approved by the Regional Water Board's Executive Officer. If less than 100-percent replacement area was previously permitted under existing individual WDRs, WQO 97-10-DWQ, or a local agency permit, the minimum reserve area previously permitted shall be maintained.

Per the General Order, burrowing animals active in areas that may result in wastewater leakage from an at-grade or above grade (mound) disposal system shall be promptly controlled and repairs to the disposal system completed as soon as possible.

D. Nitrogen Effluent Limit

Because the wastewater treatment system flow rate is less than 20,000 gpd, Regional Water Board staff did not evaluate the need for a nitrogen effluent limit. The Discharger is still required to comply with nitrogen monitoring requirements contained in the attached MRP.

E. Technical Report Requirements

Within 90 days of the issuance of an NOA, the Discharger shall prepare and implement the following, consistent with requirements from the General Order section E.1:

1. Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan
2. Written Sampling and Analysis Plan (SAP)
3. Sludge Management Plan

Annual Fees

The discharge authorized by this NOA is subject to payment of annual fees under the State Water Board annual fee schedule for regulated waste discharges. Annual fees are based in part on ratings for threat to water quality and complexity, and the treatment technology employed, as defined in the fee schedule listed in California Code of Regulations, Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 9, Waste Discharge Reports and Requirements, Article 1, Fees, Section 2200. The annual fee reflects a Threat to Water Quality and Complexity rating of 3C and a 50 percent discount because the authorized discharge is a domestic waste discharge of less than 50,000 gallons per day (gpd).

For more information on fees and answers to frequently asked questions please visit the [State Water Resources Control Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr).

Questions or concerns about this NOA letter, or related matters, should be directed to the North Coast Regional Water Board's email address at NorthCoast@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,


For

Digitally signed by
CharlesReed
Date: 2025.08.27
08:55:24 -07'00'

Valerie Quinto
Executive Officer

NOA - Plant Sciences

Attachments:

Attachment 1 – Table 1 – Summary of System Specific General Order Requirements
Attachment 2 – Monitoring and Reporting Program Order No. R1-2025-0026

cc: Richard Noonan, Nelson Land and Cattle, LLC, rnoonan@plantsciences.com
Coleman Fitzgerald, Siskiyou County, cfitzgerald@co.siskiyou.ca.us
John Anderson, Plant Sciences, janderson@plantsciences.com
Eric Levesque, Plant Sciences, edge7000@yahoo.com
Dan Scalas, Adkins Engineering and Surveying, DScalas@adkinsengineering.com
Abraham Barr, Adkins Engineering and Surveying, abarr@adkinsengineering.com

Table 1 – Summary of System Specific General Order Requirements

General Order Section	Page	Notes	Requirement (refer to General Order and NOA for details)
A. PROHIBITIONS			
A.1 - A.11	15	-	Prohibitions
B. REQUIREMENTS BY WASTEWATER TREATMENT TYPE			
B.1a - B.1l	16	-	All wastewater systems
B.1.b	16	5,040 gpd	Wastewater Flow Limit
B.2a - B.2e	20	-	Septic systems
B.6a - B.6h	24	-	Subsurface disposal systems
B.8a - B.8f	26	-	Sludge/Solids/Biosolids disposal
C. GROUNDWATER AND SURFACE WATER LIMITATIONS			
C.1a - C.1b	27	-	Narrative protections
E. PROVISIONS (technical report preparation requirements)			
E.1a	28	Have on-site	Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan
E.1b	29	Have on-site	Sampling and Analysis Plan
E.1c	30	Have on-site	Sludge Management Plan
E.2h	32	Have on-site	A copy of the NOA and General Order

The complete General Order is available at [State Water Resources Control Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf).